TidyTuesday Week 46

Pranay Gundam

Monday 9th November, 2026

Contents

1 Weekly Summary **2**

2 Date: 2026-11-09 **3**

2.1 Raw Regression 3

2.2 Detrended Regression 6

1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

This week the cosmic random-number generator reached deep into FRED's bargain bin and pulled out a truly inspired couple: the entire Rest of the World's debt securities and loans liabilities, and the amount of money people in the Plains region spend per head on housing and utilities. Naturally. Because when you think "global cross-border debt," your mind immediately leaps to a Nebraskan's gas bill. These two share a popularity score of 15 and 1 respectively, which means we've paired the mildly-known with the almost-aggressively-ignored, a match made in statistical heaven.

And oh, the raw regression. An R-squared of 0.96. Point nine six! If this were a real relationship I'd be calling a press conference, maybe accepting an award, definitely writing a smug op-ed about how the financial fate of the world is secretly written in Plains utility bills. The p-values are so small they look like typos. Truly, a thing of beauty, a near-perfect line, the kind of fit that makes you want to believe in something.

Then, as always, we detrend, and the whole cathedral collapses into a pile of bricks. Once you strip out the fact that both series simply drift upward over the decades – as basically every dollar-denominated economic series has done since the dawn of time – that glorious 0.96 shrivels to a limp 0.15. The relationship technically clings to "significant" at a p-value of 0.036, which is the statistical equivalent of a participation trophy: it showed up, it tried, we're proud of it, nobody's impressed. This is the textbook trend-mirage this project exists to gently mock: two things going up together is not a romance, it's just two escalators.

So, as ever, the mandatory disclaimer that doubles as my personal mantra: these series were paired at random, there is no theory here, no causal story, no reason on earth that world debt and Midwestern heating costs should have anything to do with each other beyond both being measured in the ever-inflating dollar. Spurious correlation isn't the bug this week, it's the entire feature. See you next week for another doomed romance between two numbers that have never met.

2 Date: 2026-11-09

Series ID: DODFFSWCMI
This series is titled Rest of the World; Debt Securities and Loans; Liability, Level and has a frequency of Quarterly, End of Period. The units are Millions of U.S. Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted Annual Rate.The observation start date is 1945-10-01 and the observation end date is 2026-04-01.The popularity of this series is 15.

Series ID: PLNSPCEPCHOUSUTL
This series is titled Per Capita Personal Consumption Expenditures: Services: Housing and Utilities for Plains BEA Region and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1997-01-01 and the observation end date is 2025-01-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_PLNSPCEPCHOUSUTL	**R-squared:**	0.961
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.959
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	660.0
Date:	Mon, 09 Nov 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	1.64e-20
Time:	21:41:25	**Log-Likelihood:**	-207.55
No. Observations:	29	**AIC:**	419.1
Df Residuals:	27	**BIC:**	421.8
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	3193.5604	115.903	27.554	0.000	2955.747	3431.374
value_fred_DODFFSWCMI	0.0008	3.03e-05	25.690	0.000	0.001	0.001

Omnibus:	0.836	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.483
Prob(Omnibus):	0.658	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	0.750
Skew:	0.053	**Prob(JB):**	0.687
Kurtosis:	2.219	**Cond. No.**	7.43e+06

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

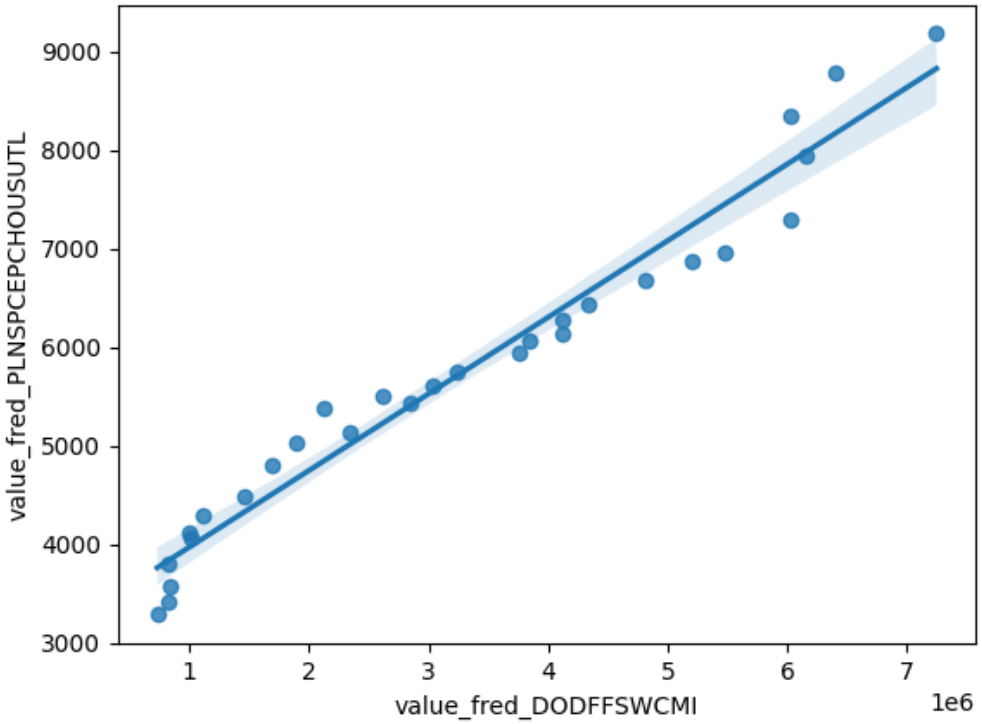


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-11-09

[2] The condition number is large, 7.43e+06. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_PLNSPCEPCHOUSUTL_detrended	**R-squared:**	0.152
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.121
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	4.857
Date:	Mon, 09 Nov 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.0363
Time:	21:41:25	**Log-Likelihood:**	-204.23
No. Observations:	29	**AIC:**	412.5
Df Residuals:	27	**BIC:**	415.2
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	-2.367e-12	53.276	-4.44e-14	1.000	-109.314	109.314
value_fred_DODFFSWCMI_detrended	0.0004	0.000	2.204	0.036	2.46e-05	0.001

Omnibus:	1.083	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.261
Prob(Omnibus):	0.582	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	0.897
Skew:	0.409	**Prob(JB):**	0.638
Kurtosis:	2.726	**Cond. No.**	3.29e+05

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 3.29e+05. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

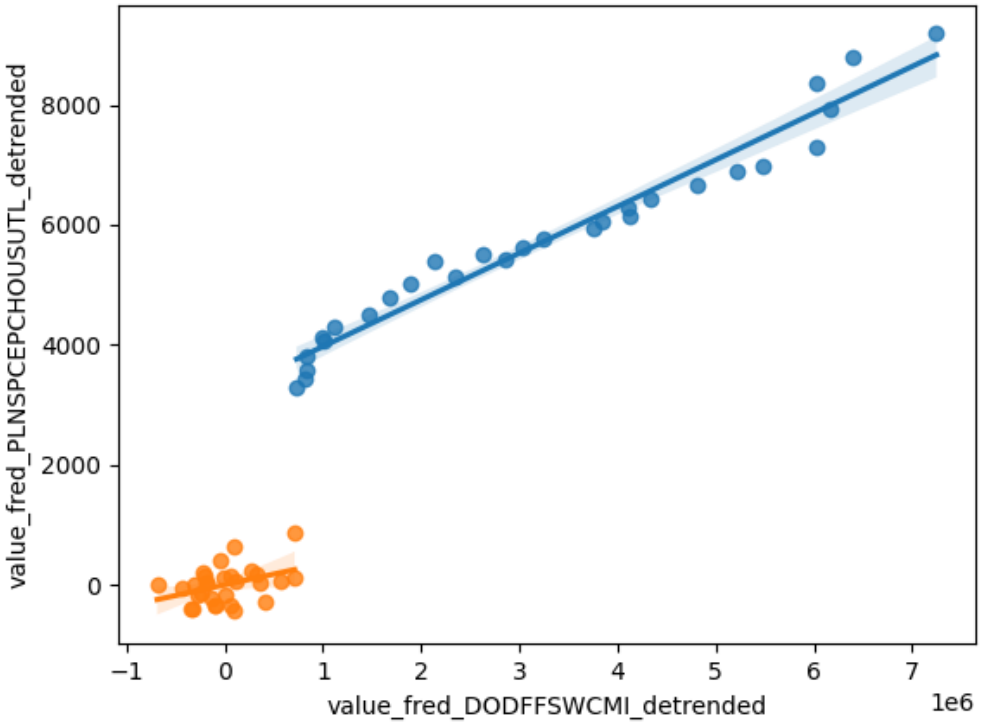


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-11-09